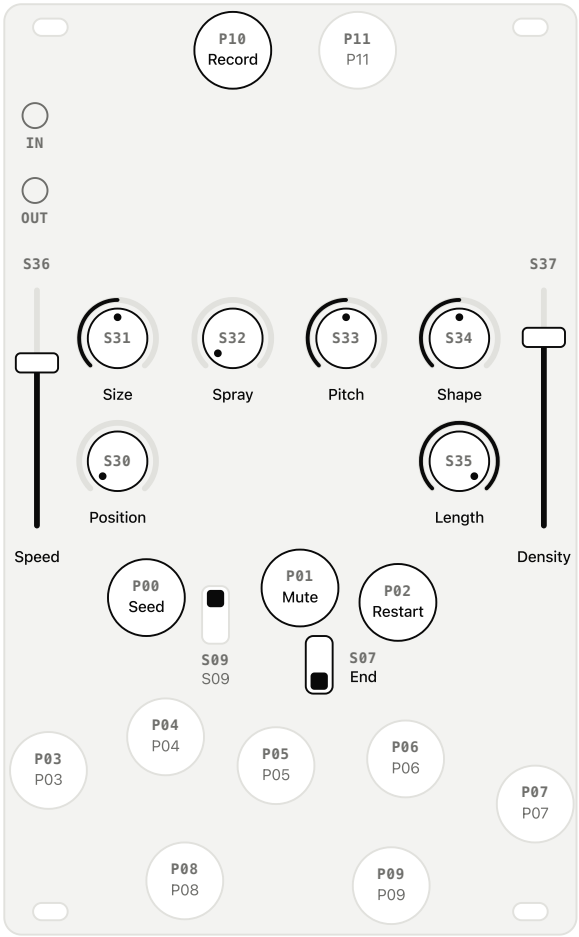
Simple Touch

Clessidra

It's the instrument where you pour grains of sound from single drops into a dense cloud.

francescodimaggio.nl/clessidra

Synthux Design Residency 2026



One layer: every control does one thing, where it is.

The selection is the sand. Speed sets how fast it runs through, Density how it falls.

Speed at its centre holds the playhead. Density at its centre: no grains but Seed.

FADERS AND KNOBS

S36	**Speed**. The time stretched, the pitch kept. Held at the centre. Up forward, down reverse. Stops at 1, 2 and 4×.
S37	**Density**. Grains at once, 1/16 to 16. None at the centre. Down: regular, drops to a stream. Up: random, scattered to a cloud. The reverb follows.
S30	**Position**. Where the sand starts, anywhere in the recording. Held: moves the point.
S35	**Length**. How much sand: the selection, past the end round to the start.
S31	**Size**. Grain length, 5 ms to 2 s, 100 ms at the centre, at most half the recording.
S32	**Spray**. How far grains stray from the playhead, evenly. Up: places, then sizes, pitch, pan, levels, reverb sends.
S33	**Pitch**. ±24 semitones. Stops at 0, 1, 3, 4, 7, 12, 24, as Beads.
S34	**Shape**. The grain's window: reverse percussive down, Hann at the centre, percussive up.

PADS AND SWITCHES

S07	**End**. When the playhead runs out: up stops, centre turns back, down loops.
P10	**Record**. Tap: the last seconds, as set. Hold: up to 30 s, the input heard.
P00	**Seed**. A touch: one grain at the playhead, whatever Density. At Density's centre, every grain is yours.
P01	**Mute**. Held: the grains silent, the reverb rings on.
P02	**Restart**. The sand back to the top: the playhead to the selection start.
S09, P03–P09, P11	Not assigned yet.

LED

Glow	Grains falling, dimmer as the sand runs out
Flashing	Recording
Pulse	At a stop: unison, speed 1× either way, 100 ms, Hann